United Nations
Educational, Scientific and
Cultural Organization

Intangible
Cultural
Heritage

Participatory video in inventorying

Unit 27 PowerPoint presentation

UNESCO
Intangible Cultural Heritage Section

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In this presentation …

- Video recording for ICH
- Basic video skills and tips
- What is participatory video?
- How to tell a story with participatory video
- Methods of participatory video
- Ethics and editing
- Uses of participatory video

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Video recording for ICH

- Provides a reasonable means of capturing moving image
- ICH elements involve living traditions and practitioners
- Changing nature of ICH
- Means of capturing the process and the product of ICH elements

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Basic video skills

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- Learn to handle the camera for
- Close up
- Long shot
- Zooming
- Panning

Documentation video tips

ICH focusses on process and not product

- Show background area – general shots
- Do short interviews to explain footage that has been shot
- Think about where close ups are needed. e.g. hand and foot movements for dance, facial expressions etc.

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What is participatory video?

- Participants and community members learn to use video recording themselves as opposed to being “shot” by experts or technicians.
- Participatory Video has been a common tool in development and for “social improvement”
- It allows the community to have its own voice
- Can create an inclusive project
- Creates ownership of the ICH as well as its documentation, and captures the living changing nature of ICH.

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Participatory video: other terms and related concepts

- Participatory film making
- Community media
- Community video

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How to tell a story

- Digital story telling or storyboards
- Plan a story
- Beginning, middle and end
- Who is telling the story?
- Plan the shots – close up, long shot, panning etc.

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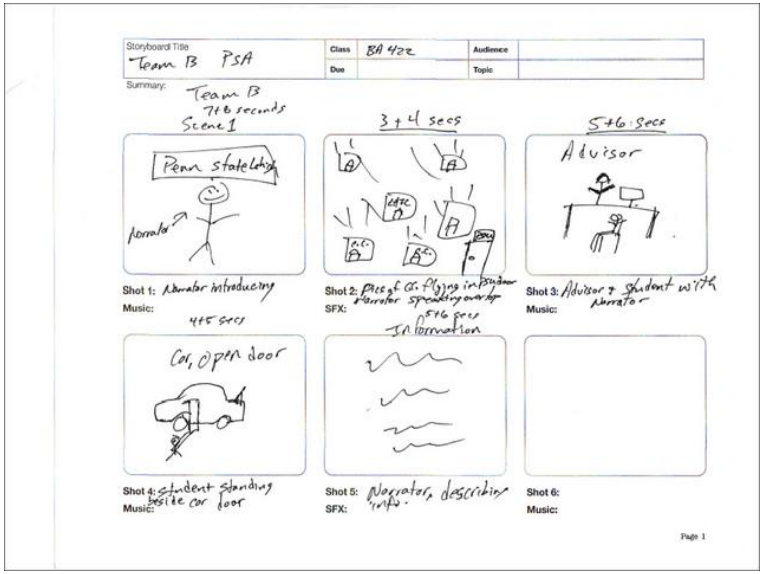
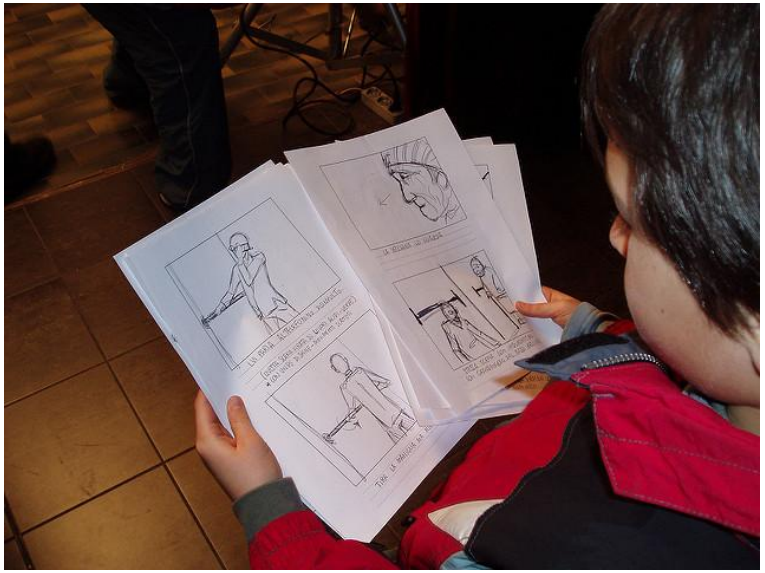
Participatory video: storyboards





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Methods of participatory video

A

- Short videos are directed by the participants.
- Footage is shown to the wider community for feedback and inputs.

B

- Recording every day life and events as they happen in context

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Methods of participatory video: a comparison

A. Short video films – stories

1. Creates a collaborative product that is easy to share

2. Authorship

3. Mediated

4. Not recorded in context

5. Voice of creator

B. Ongoing video recording

1. Not a product

2. Would tend to be an individual perspective

3. Direct

4. Recorded in context

5. Voice of practitioners

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Ethics, editing and rights

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- Whose story is it ?
- Transparency of purpose
- Community consensus and editing
- Achieving collective editing and authorship
- Acknowledgment and attribution
- Community screening
- Copyright and IPR issues

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Why use participatory video for ICH?

- Inventorying is to be carried out by the community of its own ICH
- Provides a tool for community-inventorying
- Overcomes language and literacy issues
- Video is an appropriate tool for documentation of ICH as it involves living traditions, activity, performance etc.
- Lower costs of video enable such projects
- The power of the visual medium
- Enables a community to document and transmit its ICH

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Case study: Na Modesta (Mexico)

- Desire to strengthen Binniza culture for future generations
- Na Modesta, an elder expresses her desire to document making of a traditional Zapotec dish Gueta Biza (black bean tamale)
- The community collective scripts, shoots and creates the video with the participation of the group and the community
- The video leads to further interest in documenting the Zapotec culture of Ranch Gubina
- A media centre is created for the youth to document the culture, learn technology.
- Material from the media centre to be used for informing the community, creating curricula and archival purposes.

Project of the Zapotec community based media collective in Ranchu Gubiña – Grupo Libre e Independent Binni Cubi (GLIBC) (Free and Independent New People Group)

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TFICQgID1TM

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Participatory video and ICH inventorying: questions?

- How will the community use the video ?
- Who controls rights to community video ?
- Who is the audience ?
- The role of the facilitator vs. community

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